UNDERGRADUATE ADMISSION PROCEDURE

Government Colleges in Shimla, Himachal Pradesh

Comprehensive guidance note for a unified admission platform

Prepared in simple language for students, counsellors, and the IT Administrator

Document purpose

• This note translates the current admission rules and observed college practices into a student-friendly and system-ready workflow.
• It is meant to help an IT Administrator design a single platform that can still accommodate college-wise rule variations.
• Where the uploaded prospectuses give exact rules, those rules are treated as confirmed. Where statewide practice is still unclear, the platform should keep that rule configurable.

1. Basis of this document

This guidance has been prepared from the uploaded 2025–26 prospectuses of Rajkiya Kanya Mahavidyalaya (RKMV), Shimla and Rajiv Gandhi Government College, Chaura Maidan (Sanjauli/Kotshera College), along with the current-process documentation shared for Himachal Pradesh higher education admissions.

2. What is common today and why a unified platform is needed

- Himachal Pradesh University (HPU) sets the broad admission framework, but individual colleges currently run their own intake, document verification, merit list generation, seat allotment, fee collection, and admission confirmation.
- At present there is no single state-level portal across all colleges. Students often have to repeat registration, form filling, document upload, and fee payment separately for each college.
- For the Shimla colleges covered by the uploaded prospectuses, admission to first-year undergraduate programmes is online. A common platform should therefore be built around an online-first model.

Design implication for the unified platform

• One student profile should serve many colleges.
• Rules such as eligibility, subject combinations, reservation categories, and fee heads should be configurable college-wise.
• The system should support both the common process and exceptional college-specific conditions.

3. Admission journey in plain language

1. **Step 1: Student creates an account –** Student signs up using mobile number and email. For colleges like Sanjauli, the prospectus also requires APAAR ID linked to DigiLocker and an online anti-ragging pledge before applying.
2. **Step 2: Student chooses college, course, and stream –** The platform should show all available colleges, courses, seats, eligibility, reservation categories, fees, and important dates on one screen.
3. **Step 3: Student fills academic and personal details –** This includes name, date of birth, address, category, marks, board, gap year details, and any claim under sports, cultural, PwD, EWS, or other benefits.
4. **Step 4: Student uploads documents –** The system should clearly mark mandatory and optional documents and show file-size/format guidance before submission.
5. **Step 5: Student selects subject preferences –** For courses like B.A., subject selection must follow group rules and college-specific limits. The system must block invalid combinations automatically.

6. **Step 6: College checks the form –** College staff review the application, flag discrepancies, and ask the student to correct missing or unclear documents.
7. **Step 7: Merit list is prepared –** Eligible applications are ranked according to the applicable merit formula. Reservation roster is then applied to seat allotment.
8. **Step 8: Student pays fee after selection –** Fee is paid only after the student appears in the merit list and the application is verified. Non-payment within time results in seat forfeiture.
9. **Step 9: Original documents are checked –** Even after online application, originals are commonly required at counselling or physical verification before the admission is treated as complete.
10. **Step 10: Second list and later rounds –** If some selected students do not pay or do not appear, the next merit list is published for the remaining seats.

4. Governance and responsibility matrix

Actor	Main responsibility	What the platform should support
HPU	Broad admission ordinances, eligibility norms, reservation framework, examination structure.	Central rule templates, configurable policy engine, circular-driven updates.
Department of Higher Education	Overall state oversight and administrative direction.	State admin dashboard, college onboarding, reporting and monitoring.
College Principal	Final authority at college level in disputed or exceptional cases.	Approval queues, exception logs, override rights with audit trail.
Admission Committee / Faculty	Verification of applications, eligibility, subject matching, merit list scrutiny.	Reviewer workbench, discrepancy marking, rule-based validation, remarks and recommendations.
Student	Submission of correct form, upload of documents, response to discrepancies, fee payment.	Student dashboard, alerts, checklist, status tracker, payment gateway, download receipts.

5. Confirmed reservation framework from uploaded Shimla prospectuses

Category	RKMV Shimla	Sanjauli / RGGC	System guidance
SC	15%	15%	Keep fixed, subject to latest HPU/HP Govt notification.
ST	7.5%	7.5%	Keep fixed, subject to latest HPU/HP Govt notification.
Sports	5%	5%	Require recognized sports certificates; mark as quota-based claim.
Cultural	5%	5%	Require recognized cultural participation certificates.
PwD / PC	5%	5%	Require disability certificate from competent authority.
EWS	10%	Not shown in Sanjauli roster summary but EWS documents are asked for	Keep category configurable college-wise; default support is necessary.

Single Girl Child	One extra seat over and above allotted seats in each subject	One extra seat over and above allotted seats in each subject	Treat as supernumerary seat, not part of normal seat count.

Reservation benefits in these prospectuses apply to candidates who passed the qualifying examination from H.P. Board of School Education or from schools located within the territorial jurisdiction of Himachal Pradesh, or who are bonafide residents of Himachal Pradesh. Sports and cultural quota claims must be supported by recognized participation records.

6. Domicile / bonafide status and what the platform should do

- A bonafide Himachali / H.P. domicile certificate is important for certain benefits such as tuition fee exemption for Himachali girls in the uploaded Shimla prospectuses.
- Reservation applicability in the uploaded documents refers to candidates from HP Board, schools within Himachal Pradesh, or bonafide residents of Himachal Pradesh.
- The broader statewide 75% / 25% seat split discussed in the process note is not sufficiently confirmed in the uploaded official prospectuses. Therefore that rule should not be hard-coded unless validated through the latest HPU / DHE circular.

Platform rule

• Keep domicile / school-location quota logic configurable at the state-admin level.
• Allow separate fields for: school location, bonafide resident certificate, and domicile certificate.
• Do not assume that domicile alone or school location alone settles quota eligibility until the latest circular is loaded.

7. Eligibility criteria for first-year UG admission

Programme	Confirmed minimum eligibility	Important variation / preference	Automation rule
B.A.	Pass in +2 / equivalent. RKMV states 33% marks including English. Sanjauli gives preference to Arts stream with minimum 33%.	If Mathematics is chosen in RKMV B.A., candidate must have 45% aggregate or 45% in Mathematics at +2.	Show eligible if +2 passed and required subject-specific conditions are met.
B.Sc. Medical / Non-Medical	Pass in five subjects including English, with required science combination and 45% marks.	Medical requires PCB; Non-Medical requires PCM. RKMV also allows Non-Medical choice involving Chemistry or Computer Science as applicable.	Validate stream and subject combination strictly before application submission.
B.Com.	RKMV: 33% at +2. Sanjauli: preference at 40% in Commerce stream (33% for girls); other streams need Economics or Mathematics with 45%.	This is a clear example of college-specific variation.	Make B.Com. rules college-specific instead of assuming one common threshold.
B.A. Honours / special subjects	Subject-specific seat and merit conditions apply.	For example, English Honours is separately offered in Sanjauli with limited seats.	Allow course-specific eligibility and seat configuration.

B.Voc. (RKMV sample)	10+2 in any stream; equal weightage to vocational subjects.	No age bar is mentioned for B.Voc. at RKMV.	Keep professional / skill programmes in a separate configurable module.

Common rule across the uploaded prospectuses: students who are placed under compartment or who have failed at +2 are not eligible for admission. NIOS students are accepted in Sanjauli if all five subjects have been passed with the required marks.

8. Age limitation

- Upper age limit for general undergraduate admission in the uploaded prospectuses is 23 years as on 1 July 2025.
- For girl students, the upper age limit shown is 25 years as on 1 July 2025.
- Relaxation of 3 years is available to SC/ST candidates.
- Vice-Chancellor level relaxation up to 6 months may be granted in exceptional cases.
- RKMV also notes that relaxation in upper age limit is admissible to physically challenged candidates.
- RKMV B.Voc. specifically states that there is no age bar for that course.

9. Merit list preparation

- For B.A., B.Sc., and B.Com. in the uploaded official prospectuses, merit is based on the +2 examination using the best five subjects including English.
- Sanjauli explicitly states that in case of a tie, the older candidate gets weightage.
- The field-process note suggests that some colleges may use higher marks in the relevant subject before age, but this should be treated as configurable unless confirmed through the latest HPU circular.
- Merit should be generated separately course-wise and category-wise after applying eligibility filters and the reservation roster.

Recommended system logic for merit generation

• Stage 1: Reject ineligible applications automatically.
• Stage 2: Compute merit score from best five subjects including English.
• Stage 3: Apply reservation roster and supernumerary seat logic where relevant.
• Stage 4: Apply tie-breaker sequence configured by the state admin for the academic year.
• Stage 5: Freeze merit list with an audit log before publication.

10. Subject groups, subject choices, and seat examples

The platform must not use one fixed subject-choice rule for every college. The uploaded prospectuses clearly show different B.A. groupings and different seat matrices.

10.1 B.A. subject-group rule examples

College	Confirmed choice rule	Practical system implication
RKMV Shimla	Candidate must list 4 subject choices for DSC-1. DSC-1 and DSC-2 must be from different groups. Two practical subjects cannot be taken together.	The UI should demand four ranked choices where that college requires them and should block invalid pairings automatically.
Sanjauli / RGGC	Candidate chooses two subjects, DSC-I and DSC-II, and both cannot be from the same group.	The UI should show allowed combinations only, not an open free-text choice.

10.2 Indicative subject groups from uploaded prospectuses

College	Groups in simple form	What to configure
RKMV Shimla	G1: English/Hindi/Sanskrit/Economics/Philosophy; G2: Political Science/Public Administration/JMC;	Group master, practical-subject flags, min

	G3: History/Sociology/Tourism/Education/Mathematics; G4: Geography/Physical Education/Music/Dance/Painting/Applied Art/NHE/Psychology.	and max subject choices, display sequence.
Sanjauli / RGGC	G1: English/Hindi/Sanskrit/Tourism; G2: Political Science/Public Administration/Mathematics; G3: Geography/Sociology/Music/JMC; G4: History/Economics/Philosophy/Physical Education.	Separate group mapping for each college and year.

10.3 Indicative seat matrix from uploaded Shimla prospectuses

Programme / subject	RKMV Shimla	Sanjauli / RGGC	Remark
B.Sc. Non-Medical	120	Physics 80, Mathematics 80, Chemistry 160, Computer Applications 40 (subject-wise matrix)	Science seat display may be stream-wise or subject-wise depending on college model.
B.Sc. Medical	120	Botany 80, Zoology 80, Chemistry 160	Medical / Non-Medical must be clearly separated.
B.Com.	140	180	Seat capacity differs significantly by college.
B.A. Political Science	200	240	Arts subjects may have high individual seat capacities.
B.A. History	200	240	Subject-wise seat publishing is important.
B.A. English	80	140	A unified portal must not assume same seat count across colleges.
B.A. Public Administration	80	140	College-wise difference again.
English Honours	Not shown in uploaded RKMV pages used for UG matrix	15	Honours programmes should be treated as separate courses.
B.Voc. Retail Management	40	Not in uploaded Sanjauli prospectus	Professional / skill courses need separate configuration.
B.Voc. Hospitality & Tourism	40	Not in uploaded Sanjauli prospectus	Professional / skill courses need separate configuration.

Conclusion: the platform should store seats at course level and, where required, at subject / combination level. It must also support supernumerary seats such as Single Girl Child seats.

11. Online application process and ideal platform workflow

- Registration with mobile, email, OTP verification, and password creation.
- Collection of APAAR ID and DigiLocker-linked credentials where required.
- Student profile creation: personal details, family details, academic details, category details, and communication details.
- Course and college selection with built-in eligibility checker.
- Subject preference selection with automatic validation against group rules.
- Document upload with image/PDF compression help and real-time validation.
- Auto-save draft and resume later feature.
- Submission and acknowledgment number generation.

- Discrepancy dashboard showing what is missing, who raised it, and last date for correction.
- Verified / provisionally accepted / rejected / waitlisted status labels.
- Merit list publication, fee link activation, and receipt generation only for selected candidates.
- Original document verification schedule and final admission confirmation.

12. Second merit list, later rounds, and seat forfeiture

- Both uploaded Shimla prospectuses give a clear second-merit-list schedule after the first round of fee payment.
- If a selected candidate does not remove discrepancies, does not pay fee within time, or does not complete required verification, the seat should automatically move to the next eligible candidate.
- The system should support first list, second list, and optional mop-up / manual vacancy round with separate deadlines and communication templates.
- A selected candidate who fails to deposit fee by the last date should be marked as forfeited automatically after the deadline closes.

13. Can admission happen without filling the online application?

For the Shimla government college prospectuses uploaded here, the answer is effectively no for first-year UG admission: both RKMV and Sanjauli specify online application for admission. The broader Himachal process note mentions that some colleges in the state still follow offline or paper-based processes, but that is not how the uploaded Shimla college prospectuses are framed.

Recommended policy for the unified platform

• Make online submission compulsory for all colleges participating in the unified system.
• Allow only an authorized admin-assisted application mode for exceptional cases such as notified helpdesk entry, court orders, or approved mop-up handling.
• Do not permit direct admission bypassing the application database, because that breaks merit, roster, and audit integrity.

14. Common enclosures to be uploaded

Document	When it is needed	System behaviour
Matriculation certificate / DOB proof	Mandatory for all	Mandatory upload field.
10+2 marksheet	Mandatory for all	Mandatory upload field; internet copy validity can be configured.
Passport-size photograph	Mandatory for all	Mandatory image field with size guidance.
Signature image	Common in online portals and current process documentation	Mandatory where college requires it.
Character certificate	Mandatory for regular candidates; must be recent	Mandatory upload plus issue-date validation if entered.
Category certificate (SC/ST/OBC/etc.)	Only if reservation or age relaxation is claimed	Show conditional field based on claim.
EWS certificate	Only if EWS is claimed	Conditional field.
PwD certificate	Only if disability claim is made	Conditional field with disability percentage capture.
Sports certificate	Only if sports quota is claimed	Conditional field; allow later physical submission flag if required by college.
Cultural certificate	Only if cultural quota is claimed	Conditional field; allow later physical submission flag if required by college.

H.P. domicile / bonafide certificate	For Himachali benefit / exemption / eligibility as applicable	Conditional field with purpose tag.
Migration certificate	For other boards / universities	Conditional field based on board/university selection.
Equivalence certificate	For boards other than HPBOSE / CBSE / ICSE in Sanjauli rule set	Conditional field based on board selection.
Gap year affidavit / undertaking	If there is an academic gap	Conditional field when gap years > 0.
Aadhaar card	Asked in Sanjauli admission document list and common process note	Conditional or mandatory by college.
Bank passbook front page	For scholarship / refund / identity-linked payments where required	Useful conditional field.
Single Girl Child affidavit / certificate	If claiming supernumerary benefit	Conditional field.
Ex-serviceman / ward / freedom fighter certificate	If such category benefit is claimed	Conditional field.

15. Indicative fee structure for platform display

The uploaded files do not give one complete common fee schedule for all Shimla colleges and all UG programmes. Therefore the table below is intentionally labelled indicative. It mixes observed statewide ranges with the concrete examples present in the uploaded prospectuses.

Programme / fee head	Indicative amount	Source type	Platform recommendation
General UG programmes (B.A. / B.Sc. / B.Com.)	Typically about Rs. 2,000 to Rs. 4,000 per year	Observed statewide process note	Show college-specific fee breakup on the payment page, not just a single total.
Professional / self-financing UG courses (e.g., BCA / BBA where offered)	Typically about Rs. 10,000 to Rs. 15,000 per year	Observed statewide process note	Keep separate fee template for self-financing programmes.
RKMV B.Voc. sample total	Rs. 3,662	Concrete uploaded prospectus page	Useful as an example of detailed fee-head display.
Tuition fee for non-Himachali girls at RKMV	Rs. 50 per month	Concrete uploaded prospectus page	Apply conditional fee waiver based on bonafide Himachali status.
Science practical fee at RKMV	Rs. 20 per month per subject	Concrete uploaded prospectus page	Compute programme fee dynamically by selected practical subjects.
Other practical subjects at RKMV (Geography, Music, Psychology, etc.)	Rs. 15 per month per subject	Concrete uploaded prospectus page	Needs subject-linked fee logic.
Home Science practical fee at RKMV	Rs. 25 per month	Concrete uploaded prospectus page	Needs subject-linked fee logic.
Late fee at Sanjauli	Rs. 10 per day	Concrete uploaded prospectus page	Automate delay penalty where college enables it.

Fee waivers / concessions explicitly visible in the uploaded documents include tuition-fee exemption for Himachali girls and disability-based exemption in certain cases. Therefore the payment engine should not be a flat amount engine; it should be a rule-driven fee engine.

16. Student-centric features that will genuinely ease the process

- Single sign-on and one reusable student profile for all participating colleges.
- Eligibility checker before form submission so students know instantly whether they can apply.
- Smart subject-choice assistant that allows only valid group combinations.
- Bilingual, plain-language interface with mobile-first screens.
- Auto-save draft and resume later.
- One-click document compression / crop / rotate / preview support before upload.
- Discrepancy tracker with red-yellow-green status and last date to correct.
- SMS, WhatsApp, email, and in-app notifications for deadlines, objections, merit lists, and payments.
- Merit list dashboard that clearly shows selected / waiting / not eligible / discrepancy pending status.
- Fee calculator showing why the amount is what it is, including concessions and practical-fee additions.
- Appointment slot booking for physical verification to avoid crowding.
- Downloadable application PDF, acknowledgment slip, receipt, and final provisional admission letter.
- Accessibility support for low-bandwidth users, screen readers, and assisted application mode at help desks.
- Helpdesk ticketing with escalation to college and state admin.
- A grievance / appeal window with reason capture and audit trail.

17. Core admin features required on the backend

- College-wise rule configuration for eligibility, subject groups, fees, documents, and seat matrix.
- Reservation and roster engine with category percentages, supernumerary seats, and annual updates.
- Merit generator with configurable tie-breaker order.
- Bulk discrepancy marking and bulk communication tools.
- Audit trail for every action: edit, rejection, approval, fee activation, override, and seat movement.
- Exception-handling panel for age relaxation, court orders, migration disputes, and manual approvals.
- Role-based access for state admin, principal, admission committee, reviewer, cashier, and helpdesk operator.
- Vacancy dashboard for second and mop-up rounds.
- MIS and analytics on applications, category mix, payments, unfilled seats, and bottlenecks.
- Archival and export support for compliance and future admission cycles.

18. Key implementation cautions

- Do not hard-code every rule as common across all Shimla colleges. The uploaded prospectuses already show variation in subject groups, seat counts, and some eligibility thresholds.
- Keep fee heads configurable. A flat “single amount” model will fail once practical subjects, concessions, and course-specific charges are applied.
- Keep quota / domicile logic configurable until the latest HPU / DHE circular is loaded into the platform.
- Make online application, verification status, and merit audit trails non-bypassable so that admissions remain defensible and transparent.